

CityTech TTP Summer Bootcamp

Full-Stack Development and Mutations

2026-07-02

Agenda

1. Review
2. Follow-Ups
3. TanStack Query Mutations
4. Celebrity Name Chain

Review

What are the most important things you remember from yesterday?

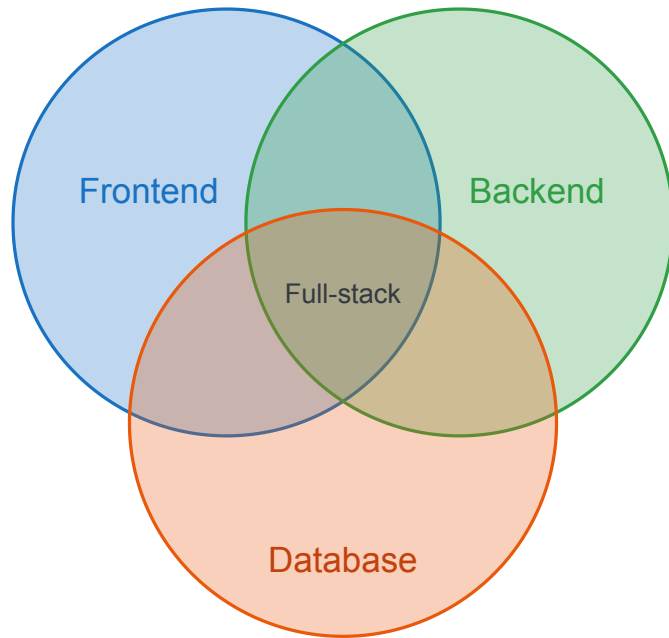
Follow Up: The Polling Demo

Yesterday's **TanStack Query polling** example is now in the repo, as a live message board:

- **server/** — a tiny Express API: **GET /** lists messages, **POST /** adds one
- **client/** — an Ionic app that **polls** **GET /**, so new messages appear on their own
- Run the server, expose it with **ngrok**, then **POST** with Insomnia to watch polling work

Code: `demos/tanstack-polling ( server/ + client/ )`

Follow Up: Full-Stack Development



A web app is built in three major layers:

- **Frontend** — the UI users see (React, Ionic)
- **Backend** — server, logic, and APIs (Express)
- **Database** — where the data lives (PostgreSQL)

Where all three meet is **full-stack**.

Follow Up: Which Layers Should You Learn?

One layer (specialist)

- Pro: deep expertise, clear roles (frontend, backend, DBA); valued at larger companies
- Con: fewer roles fit you, and you rely on others to ship a whole feature

Two layers (e.g. frontend + backend)

- Pro: knowing one sharpens the other (e.g. frontend that slots cleanly into your backend); very hireable
- Con: still lean on a specialist for the third (often the database or ops)

All three (full-stack)

- Pro: build a whole app end to end; ideal for startups, small teams, and prototypes
- Con: hard to go deep everywhere; risk of "jack of all trades, master of none"

TanStack Query: Mutations

`useQuery` **reads** data (`GET`). `useMutation` **changes** it: create, update, delete (`POST` , `PUT` , `DELETE`).

- A mutation does **not** run on its own; you call `mutate(...)` when ready (e.g. on submit)
- It tracks status: `isPending` while it runs, plus `error` and an `onSuccess` callback
- On success, `invalidateQueries` marks the matching query stale so it **refetches** the fresh data

Docs: <https://tanstack.com/query/latest/docs/framework/react/guides/mutations>

Example: `useMutation`

A mutation that posts a new message, then refetches the list:

```
const queryClient = useQueryClient();
const { mutate, isPending } = useMutation({
  mutationFn: (newMsg) =>
    fetch(`${API_URL}/`, {
      method: "POST",
      headers: { "Content-Type": "application/json" },
      body: JSON.stringify(newMsg),
    }).then((r) => r.json()),
  onSuccess: () =>
    queryClient.invalidateQueries({ queryKey: ["messages"] }),
});
```

Call `mutate({ name, message })` on submit. `isPending` **disables the button** while it posts; `onSuccess` refetches the list.

Celebrity Name Chain

Pick up your **Celebrity Name Chain** project and keep building.

- Start from the template repo (**Use this template**, one repo per team)
- Bring together everything: **Ionic, RHF, TanStack Query**, and your **Express + Prisma API**
- Full spec: `project_specs/celebrity-name-chain.md`

Today's Exit Ticket

- [] Submit your **Celebrity Name Chain** repo link to the **Google Form** on Slack
- [] Explain the **overall design** of your approach to the project
- [] Explain and use **useQuery** and **useMutation** in TanStack Query